

INTELLIGENCE BRIEF / N° 154 · HOT

Horizon3.ai

Cybersecurity · Autonomous Penetration Testing · San Francisco (offices in Amsterdam, Australia, Singapore) · Private (\$2B+; \$250M Series E, Aug 2026)

Horizon3, the San Francisco security company whose NodeZero platform attacks customers' networks the way an adversary would, announced a \$250M Series E at a valuation above \$2B on 3 August, co-led by NightDragon and NEA, tripling the \$650M price of its June 2025 Series D in little over a year.

78
OPPORTUNITY / 100

TIMING WINDOW

HOT

SERIES

F1

RECOMMENDED TEAM

Cadillac F1 Team

ACTION HORIZON

6-10 WKS

THE CASE

The oversubscribed round brought in Acrew, Blue Cloud Ventures, Demeter, Singapore's EDBI, PSG, SAIC and Sapphire, with Craft, Prosperity7, Qualcomm Ventures, Ridge and SignalFire returning. The company reports 120% year-on-year ARR growth and more than 7,000 organisations protected, four of them Fortune 10; TechCrunch puts ARR near \$100M (reported). Founders Snehal Antani and Anthony Pillitiere met at Joint Special Operations Command, where Antani was first CTO from 2018 after three years as CTO of Splunk. The money funds international expansion, with offices opened in Amsterdam in June, Australia and Singapore, and a partner network.

Cybersecurity is the most-sold technology category on the grid: CrowdStrike at Mercedes, Bitdefender at Ferrari, Keeper at Williams, Okta and Rubrik at McLaren, Cato Networks at Alpine, and Red Bull's 1Password. Every one sells defence. Horizon3 sells the attack, continuously, and its new CMO Andres Botero ran marketing at Rubrik in the period its McLaren partnership was being built. A category leader with no seat, and a marketer who has watched one taken.

WHY NOW

The round closed on 3 August, a CMO arrived in January with a category-leadership mandate, and offices are opening on three continents. The United States GP in Austin (late October) and Las Vegas (November) fall inside the window, and teams close 2027 rosters in the fourth quarter.

PROOF POINTS — EVERY FIGURE VERIFIED TO A PRIMARY SOURCE (SEE P.2)

\$250M

\$250M Series E at a valuation above \$2B, announced 3 Aug 2026, co-led by NightDragon and NEA; triples the \$...

\$100M

ARR approaching \$100M with 120% year-on-year ARR growth (company release; TechCrunch, reported)

120%

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GRID FIT — CATEGORY-WHITESPACE CHECK ACROSS THE F1 GRID (SPONSOR TABLE; 55 OF 346 PARTNER ROWS CATEGORISED)

Cadillac F1 Team ◆ RECOMMENDED	PRIME LANE	greenfield entry — partner roster being built from zero
McLaren Mastercard F1 Team	TAKEN	Okta, Rubrik
BWT Alpine F1 Team	TAKEN	Cato Networks, SEALSQ
Mercedes-AMG Petronas F1 Team	TAKEN	CrowdStrike

BOTTOM LINE

\$250M at more than \$2B, 120% ARR growth, a CMO who has seen an F1 deal built and an open cybersecurity lane at the American debutant put Horizon3 at peak authority to move, with Austin and Las Vegas inside the window. The TWG AI exclusivity and a premium first-deal price hold the score at 78.

FUNDING EVENT CATEGORY PRECEDENT LEADERSHIP TIE DISCOVERY: SCAN

WHY CADILLAC F1 TEAM

Cadillac is the American debutant building its technology roster from scratch under a stated 'fewer, bigger, better' partner policy: IFS runs the enterprise stack, Core Scientific the data centre, TWG AI the exclusive AI programme. It carries no cybersecurity partner, so Official Cybersecurity Partner is cleanly ownable. A first-season estate across Fishers, Charlotte and Silverstone has never been tested in anger, and Horizon3's defence-rooted American story suits a GM-backed flag-bearer.

VALUE TO CADILLAC F1 TEAM — MODE A (TECH IN THE CAR / CHAMPIONSHIP)

MODE A - operational. NodeZero runs autonomous penetration tests continuously across the team's estate: the Fishers and Silverstone factory networks, the garage network rebuilt at every circuit, supplier and partner integrations, and the Core Scientific and TWG AI environments. Findings are ranked by exploitability and re-tested after each fix, so a small security staff works on what an attacker would actually use.

DEAL ARCHITECTURE

Entry as Official Cybersecurity Partner. **THREE YEARS**, 2027-2029, spanning the international build-out. Estimated \$4-6M a year, part-payable in NodeZero licences. Scope: car and garage placement, naming of the team's security-validation programme, Austin and Las Vegas hospitality for CISOs and federal buyers, content on how a new team defends itself.

PRIMARY DECISION-MAKER

Andres Botero

CHIEF MARKETING OFFICER, HORIZON3.AI · VERIFIED

Botero joined on 7 January 2026 from Rubrik, where he was CMO through its April 2024 IPO and while the McLaren partnership announced on 28 January was built; his part in that deal is not confirmed. Sponsor: Snehal Antani, co-founder and CEO. Path: Holly Grey, CFO, and Matt Hartley, CRO.

OPENING ANGLE

Lead with Rubrik and the empty lane.

“Andres, you were at Rubrik while its McLaren deal came together. Cadillac has no cybersecurity partner and a first-season estate nobody has attacked yet. 25 minutes before Austin to see what NodeZero on a Formula 1 team looks like?”

SCORE COMPOSITION

TIMING 18 / 20 Round announced 3 Aug; Austin and Las Vegas inside the window.	CAPACITY 17 / 20 \$250M at \$2B+; ARR near \$100M growing 120% (reported).	BRAND FIT 15 / 20 American, defence-rooted B2B brand; CISO and federal audience.	URGENCY 12 / 20 Expansion and new CMO, but no listing date or hard deadline.	OPS FIT 16 / 20 MODE A: continuous autonomous pentesting of a new estate.
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RISKS & COUNTERS

TWG AI EXCLUSIVITY TWG AI is Cadillac's exclusive AI partner; an 'AI vs AI' security brand could be read as an AI partner and blocked. **Counter:** Enter as cybersecurity, position NodeZero as security validation, and clear the language with TWG first.

FIRST SPORTS DEAL Horizon3 has never run a sports partnership, and Cadillac's 'fewer, bigger, better' policy is priced for large cheques. **Counter:** Use Botero's Rubrik playbook and pay part of the fee in licences the team would otherwise buy.

SOURCES — 15 OF 15 LOAD-BEARING CLAIMS VERIFIED

- https://horizon3.ai/news/press-release/horizon3-appoints-chief-marketing-officer/
- https://horizon3.ai/news/press-release/horizon3-raises-250m-series-e-at-2b-valuation-to-lead-the-ai-vs-ai-cybersecurity-era/
- https://techcrunch.com/2026/08/03/horizon3-hits-2-billion-valuation-with-250m-series-e-as-ai-threats-escalate/
- https://www.securityweek.com/horizon3-raises-250-million-to-fund-continuing-growth/